

Canonical Influence Map

Intellectual Lineage of the Reality Drift Framework – A. Jacobs

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The Reality Drift framework emerges from a synthesis of multiple intellectual traditions. Its structure reflects convergences across systems theory, cybernetics, media theory, philosophy, institutional analysis, and cognitive inquiry. The following figures represent primary structural influences on the framework and help situate its conceptual lineage.

Alfred Korzybski provides one of the deepest epistemic foundations of the framework through his work on abstraction, representation, and the distinction between symbolic maps and underlying reality. His influence is especially visible in the Reality Drift treatment of semantic compression, representational layering, and the structural risks that emerge when systems begin optimizing the map over the territory.

Gregory Bateson provides one of the deepest methodological foundations of the framework through his work on recursive systems, feedback loops, ecological mind, and the relational structure of information. His insistence that pattern and relation precede isolated objects remains central to the Reality Drift method.

Norbert Wiener provides the cybernetic foundation of feedback, control, communication, and signal integrity. His influence is especially visible in the framework's concern with degraded correction loops, systemic adaptation, and representational distortion.

Claude Shannon contributes the compression layer of the framework. His work on information theory, signal loss, and transmission constraints shapes the Reality Drift analysis of semantic compression, fidelity degradation, and the tradeoffs inherent in abstraction.

Terrence Deacon contributes the framework's concern with emergence, constraint, symbolic incompleteness, and the causal role of absence in complex systems. His work informs the Reality Drift analysis of how meaning, structure, and representation stabilize through layered constraints while remaining vulnerable to distortion through abstraction and compression.

Marshall McLuhan contributes the environmental dimension of the framework. His work on media as world-shaping infrastructure informs the analysis of how representational systems alter cognition, perception, and social organization before their effects become consciously legible.

Niklas Luhmann provides the structural logic of self-referential systems. His analysis of autopoiesis, operational closure, and systemic reproduction directly informs the framework's understanding of how institutions maintain coherence while drifting from external reality.

Karl Polanyi contributes the grounding layer of embeddedness. His work clarifies how abstracted systems can become dislocated from the material and social substrates that originally stabilized them, a dynamic central to the framework's concern with drift under abstraction.

Karl Marx contributes an early structural analysis of abstraction, mediation, and the separation of systems from lived material conditions. His influence is most visible in the framework's treatment of inversion, proxy logic, and the detachment of institutional processes from their original grounding.

Julian Jaynes informs the framework's historical and cognitive dimensions, especially around shifts in internal representation, consciousness, and the evolving structure of selfhood.

The Reality Drift framework should not be understood as a direct extension of any single thinker, but as a contemporary synthesis operating across their overlapping structural concerns. Its primary contribution lies in tracing how these dynamics converge under modern conditions of scale, mediation, optimization, and artificial cognition.